

Core workflow

The Project Helix workflow has seven steps. Use the sidebar to navigate each step in order.

Overview

- Steps 1–4¹ — Claim a task, understand the repo, set up Docker, and build your golden solution.
- Steps 5–7² — Write fail-to-pass tests, create metadata & LLM prompt, and submit your PR.

- 1. Setup and solution development
- 2. Testing, metadata, and submission

Before you start

Verify environment setup first

Before starting core workflow, verify that your Environment Setup PR checks have passed and the PR is merged. If checks have not passed: raise it in the Slack group with your Task ID + PR link, and pause work on that task. You can work on another task in the meantime.

Time and tools

Plan for **5–8 hours per task**. There is an **8-hour cap per task** and a **40-hour weekly cap**.

You'll use the **Handshake AI platform**, **GitHub**, and your **local IDE**. Communication runs through Slack (`helix-tasking` , `helix-announcements`).

Docker seeding tasks

Some tasks are **Docker Seeding Tasks** — the repo has no Docker setup yet. If your task is designated that way, follow the [Env Setup](#) workflow first, then continue from Step 4.

Commit structure

Every PR must have exactly **three commits** on your `golden-solution` branch, in this order:

1. ``[sol]``¹ — Golden solution feature code.
2. ``[f2p]``² — All fail-to-pass test cases.
3. ``[meta]``³ — `metadata.json` file.

- 1. Required — your fix or feature implementation
- 2. Required — tests that prove your fix works

Optional: use `[dep]` for dependency updates to baseline the repo (before `[sol]`).

Strict commit limit

Extra commits beyond `[sol]`, `[f2p]`, and `[meta]` will result in the task being sent back. All commits related to `.helix` script files must be made on the `docker-golden-solution` branch — not on `golden-solution`.

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